



DoView Tool B20 - Determining Whose Outcomes - Citizen or Government's - The Rationales for Government Assistance Framework

When developing DoView strategy/outcomes diagrams, one needs to have some clarity about: 'whose outcomes' should be driving the particular government service provision - citizens and/or governments? The particular outcomes specified for government activity described in a particular strategy/outcomes diagram are influenced by the rationale for government assistance to citizens under which that activity is operating. At least four rationales for government assistance to citizens can be identified and are set out below. Next to each is a description of the implications for the outcomes that will drive activity under that rationale.

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| 1 | Things all citizens have a statutory right to (e.g. voting, rule of law). | Citizens' legal rights determine outcomes. |
| 2 | Services that a government may want to provide to all citizens (e.g. infrastructure, education, health). | Mix of citizen-needs and what government is prepared to provide determine outcomes. |
| 3 | Assisting people who are not getting a 'fair go' so that they can compete on a more level playing field. | Disadvantaged citizens' needs within the envelope of outcomes for which government decides to attempt to re-create a level playing field determine outcomes. |
| 4 | Reducing likely cost of government services provided in the future to people who currently face social problems. | Disadvantaged citizens' needs within the envelope of those problems that, if addressed, will result in a reduction in future social spending, determine outcomes. |